

Apartment setup checklist

Move-in order: keys, meters, internet, garbage, and mail you cannot miss.

Before you turn the key

- ☐ Photos of every wall, floor, and appliance for move-out later.
- ☐ Test all burners, hot water, AC remote, and breaker labels on day one.
- ☐ Confirm who pays which fee: fire insurance, key replacement, parking.

Utilities and safety

- ☐ Electric contract in your name from start date. Gas often needs an appointment for activation.
- ☐ Water is usually simpler but still confirm valve location and shutoff direction.
- ☐ Smoke detector test. Fire extinguisher location if provided.

Internet and work from home

- ☐ Fiber install can slip weeks in busy seasons. Mobile hotspot backup for remote work.
- ☐ Router placement near the fiber port. Ask building rules about wall mounts.
- ☐ Write down PPPoE or provider login once the tech leaves.

Mail and neighbors

- ☐ Name on mailbox must match registration where required. Misdelivery is common early.
- ☐ Intro note optional but quiet hours matter more than gifts.
- ☐ Package labels in Japanese help couriers when your building has no concierge.